

premature. "We did see a lot of support but support is different from loyalty." Loyalty to him is a Mumbai boy walking down a street in a Mumbai Indians T-shirt in a few months time.

The franchises know what they want and their collective strength could, many believe, soon work like an opposition lobby to the BCCI in itself. Should the IPL be even more profitable there is no reason owners will not demand longer seasons, more games, more rights, more control.

But BCCI president-elect Shashank Manohar who was seen only at the opening game before going on vacation is not worried. "There's no threat of a corporate takeover of the Board," he said, "corporates may know how to organise matches now and how to spend money but the donkey work at the games was done mostly by the state associations."

Every state association will receive in the region of Rs 6-7 crore from the IPL's earnings on the

condition that the money is used for developing and upgrading infrastructure. But the feeling of being shoved to the side while the movie stars and business moguls grab centrestage and hand out trophies is one that the BCCI's old-world mandarins did not take kindly to.

"This will naturally cause conflict in the long run," former BCCI president Jagmohan Dalmiya told INDIA TODAY, "even in this tournament, cricket administrators had very little say." In this scenario, BCCI treasurer N. Srinivasan's bid for a Chennai franchise and the involvement of Brijesh Patel in the Bangalore Royal Challengers has ensured that the two men retain complete control of their state associations, even during cricket's 'corporate governance' weeks. "Everyone is disgruntled," said a Board insider, "but no one in the IPL has had to give answers be-

NEW STARS SOME SURPRISING FACES, SOME FAMILIAR PROSPECTS.



VIJAYAN SUDHANA

MANPREET GONY (CHENNAI)
Matches: 16 Wkts: 17
Avg: 26.05



PTI

PIYUSH CHAWLA (MOHALI)
Matches: 15 Wkts: 17
Avg: 22.88



PTI

YUSUF PATHAN (JAIPUR)
Matches: 16 Runs: 435
Wkts: 8 Batting avg: 31.07